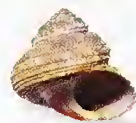




Skeletons



Elephant skull

The long tusks are actually teeth!

A set of bones, an outer case, a beautiful shell – almost all animals have some sort of skeleton. Skeletons support the body and protect the soft parts inside.

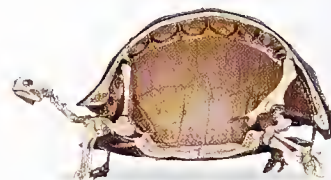
Long, light bones help the cat run faster.



Human skull

The large skull encloses a big brain.

Animal skeletons



Tortoises have an inner skeleton joined to their exoskeleton, or shell.

Snakes can curl up because they have hundreds of bones in their spine.



Fish have long, bendy spines to help them move through water.

Birds have hollow bones, which make them light enough to fly in the air.



Frogs have short spines, but long back legs that are good for jumping.

Cat skeleton

Without a skeleton, most animals, like this cat, would be floppy bags of skin with no shape!

Sharp claws to catch prey

Spine is long and bendy

Rib cage protects heart and lungs

Long, pointed teeth to kill prey

Skull

Hips

Long tail for balance

Exoskeleton

Many animals have a hard case or shell on the outside of their body. It is called an exoskeleton.

Beetle



Stiff plates make a hard casing that protects the beetle's soft body.

Shells

Some shells get bigger as the animal grows.



Shedding exoskeletons

As a crab grows, it gets too big for its shell. So it wriggles out of its old shell and grows a new, larger one.



Did you know?

Worms have no bones at all. They are filled with fluid, which gives them their shape.

